

Karim Valiev

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🇬🇧 UK Global Talent visa holder, based in 🇧🇪 Tbilisi, Georgia

Summary

10+ years in cybersecurity / engineering. Deep hands-on with Python, Linux, networking and DBs. Built security tools and designed infrastructure at scale. Experienced in leading technical teams and mentoring engineers while staying deeply involved in the code.

🔧 Core Skills

- **Dev:** Python, Go, C/C++, Linux kernel & eBPF, Docker/K8s, KVM/QEMU, CI/CD (Ansible, GitHub Actions), MySQL, Elasticsearch, AWS & GCP
 - **Networking:** TCP/IP (L2–L4), Firewalls, datacenter & office networks, VLANs, scapy
 - **Security:** Pentesting & Bug Bounty, Incident Response / SOC, Vuln Mgmt & Code Audits, PKI & Cryptography
 - **Mobile / IoT:** Android internals (NDK, Magisk, Frida), ESP8266/ESP32, Bluetooth & Zigbee, Home Assistant & esphome
 - **Leadership:** 7 yrs tech management — hiring, mentoring, project & security program delivery
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👛 Experience

Founder & Developer, Attack Surface Management Tool (2022–now)

- Entire system built myself, except React dashboard: Python scheduler + custom & OSS modules, mapping 100k+ hosts in real time
- Tuned scanning pipeline to sustain 99% CPU / 90% RAM under load, with congestion and packet-loss controls; results indexed in MySQL and Elasticsearch
- One-click deploy (Ansible, Docker, GitHub Actions) on cloud + bare-metal; React dashboard and Telegram alerts; full test/profiling suite

CISO, VK / Mail.Ru (2017–2021)

- Built company-wide security program for 100+ products; scaled team 7 → 50, established per-product security units, and launched a 24×7 SOC + IR center
- Hardened infrastructure: per-service firewalls, YubiKey-based SSH/VPN, certificate Wi-Fi, automated vuln scanning; built and ran a top-7 global HackerOne bug-bounty and recurring 3rd-party red-team exercises
- Led incident response for major breaches, drove M&A security, and served as public security ambassador (conferences, crisis comms, CTF team)

Security Team Lead, Mail.Ru email and portal BU, VK (2014–2017)

Security Analyst, Mail.Ru email and portal BU, VK (2013–2014)

Software Developer, Stream.Ru (2012–2013)

Community & Recognition

- **Open-source:**

<https://github.com/valievkarim/spinrun> - tool to boot a clean, disposable Alpine Linux VM using QEMU in < 0.7s

Bugfixes to public projects: Ansible community.general (2025, included in Ansible), Nuclei scanner (2023), SQLAlchemy (2022), html5lib (2013), MediaInfo (2013)

- **Vulnerability research:**

Featured in Halls of Fame from [Google](#), [Yandex](#), [Mozilla](#), Microsoft, [Alibaba](#) and [Salesforce](#) (2015–2021)

- **CTF:**

Founded VK team – ranked #7 in Russia (2020–2021)

Former core player, MSU “Bushwhackers” – multiple #1 RU/international wins (2010–2015)

- **Public speaking:**

- Launch is Tomorrow podcast – [modern auth](#) (2024), [security at scale](#) (2019)
- Standoff conf – panel on [cybersecurity careers](#) (2021)
- Previous talks – [applied crypto](#) (2017), [social media monitoring](#) (2014), [scanner benchmarking](#) (2012)

Education

M.Sc. Mathematics & Computer Science, Moscow State University (2008–2013)